

Externally owned account (EOA). An *Ethereum* account controlled by a specific user.

Fiat currency. Uncollateralized paper currency, which is essentially an IOU issued by a government.

Fintech. Abbreviation for financial technology, a general term that refers to technological advances in finance. Broadly includes technologies in the payments, trading, borrowing, and lending spaces, and often big data and machine learning applications.

Flash loan. An uncollateralized loan with zero counterparty risk and zero duration. Used to facilitate arbitrage or to refinance a loan without pledging collateral. Has no counterparty risk because in a single transaction (a) the loan is created, (b) all buying and selling using the loan funding is completed, and (c) the loan is paid in full.

Flash swap. Feature of some *DeFi* protocols whereby a contract sends tokens before the user pays for them with assets on the other side of the pair. Allows for near-instantaneous arbitrage. Allows for flexibility of repaying with a different asset, which is different from a *flash loan*, which must be repaid with the same asset. A key feature is that all trades occur within a single *Ethereum* transaction.

Fork. In the context of open source code, an upgrade or enhancement to an existing protocol that connects to the protocol's history. A user has the choice of using the old or the new protocol. If the new protocol is better and attracts